US sports-betting affiliate analytics: a case study for PLAYERSBEST

OVERVIEW

Six questions a BI analyst at a lead-generation affiliate answers every week - deal economics, channel and page value, A/B testing, forecasting and data quality - worked end to end with SQL (DuckDB), Python and Power BI.

PUBLIC · PAGE 1

37%

of Gambling.com Group's performance-marketing revenue came from CPA deals in 2025, down from 58% in 2023

SIMULATED · PAGE 2

$8.07 vs $1.11

12-month affiliate revenue per visit: bonus-code pages vs news pages

SIMULATED · PAGE 3

Month 8

when casino revenue share overtakes a $400 CPA; for sportsbook it never does within 24 months

SIMULATED · PAGE 6

3 / 3

injected anomalies caught by ratio rules within 3 days, with zero false alarms

Business questions

1 · Market How do listed affiliates make money, US vs Europe?
2 · Channels Which channels and pages bring NDCs, at what EPC and ROI?
3 · Deals CPA or revenue share: which is worth more, and when?
4 · A/B test Does the new landing page lift conversion?
5 · Forecast Traffic and NDCs for the 2026-27 NFL season
6 · Data quality Catch bot clicks, broken tracking and search shifts early

Recommendation: negotiate CPA with sportsbooks and revenue share with casinos, push traffic to bonus-code and comparison pages, keep the old landing page, and monitor ratios daily.

Data & methods

PUBLIC Gambling.com Group, Better Collective and Catena Media filings, each figure sourced.
PUBLIC DATASET landing-page A/B test, 290,584 users.
SIMULATED two NFL seasons of sessions, click-outs, NDCs, player NGR and paid spend for a US affiliate (9 states, fictional operators).

SQL censoring-safe cohort curves, EPC by channel and page, daily KPIs (DuckDB).
Python z-test, bootstrap, power and peeking simulation; calendar GLM forecast with back-test; robust anomaly rules.
Power BI star schema, DAX measures, one question per page.

How to read this report

Titles state the conclusion. **Tags** PUBLIC / PUBLIC DATASET / SIMULATED mark where the data comes from. **NDC** new depositing customer. **EPC** affiliate revenue per click-out to an operator.

Data sources listed in SOURCES.md · Independent case study · Not affiliated with PLAYERSBEST (formerly Growth Leads)

Listed affiliates are moving from one-off CPA fees to recurring revenue share

PUBLIC DATA

At Gambling.com Group, CPA fell from 58% to 37% of performance-marketing revenue in two years. Better Collective earns 55% of European revenue from revenue share but only 24% in North America, where it is converting CPA deals (North America CPA revenue roughly halved in 2025). Revenue per NDC rises as NDC volumes fall. Next frontier: Better Collective names prediction markets as a 2026 tailwind.

Gambling.com Group revenue 2025

$165,4 m

North America share of its revenue, 2025

53%

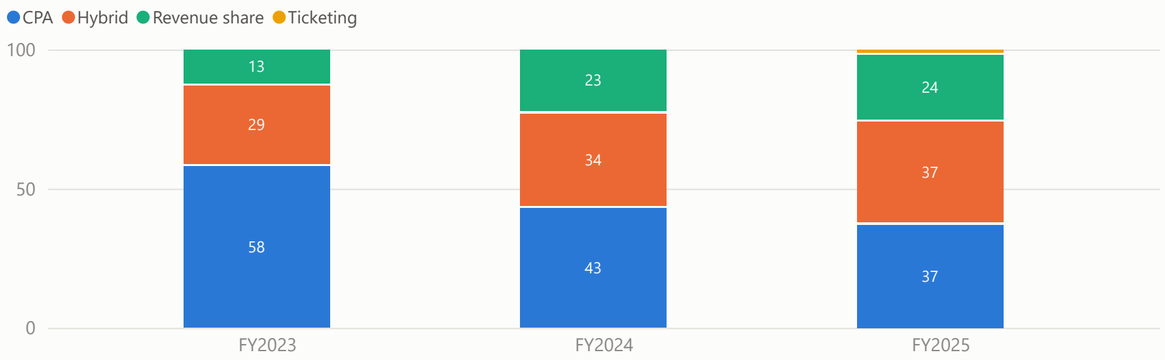
CPA share of its performance marketing, 2025

37%

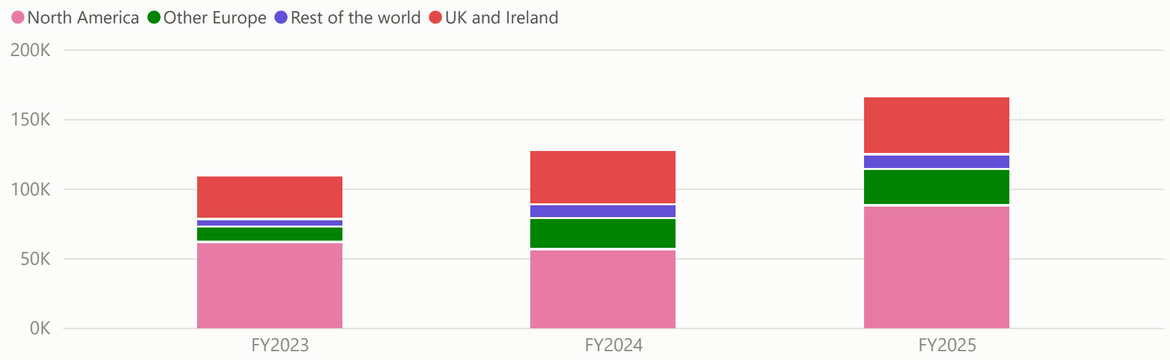
Better Collective: revenue share in North America revenue, 2025

24%

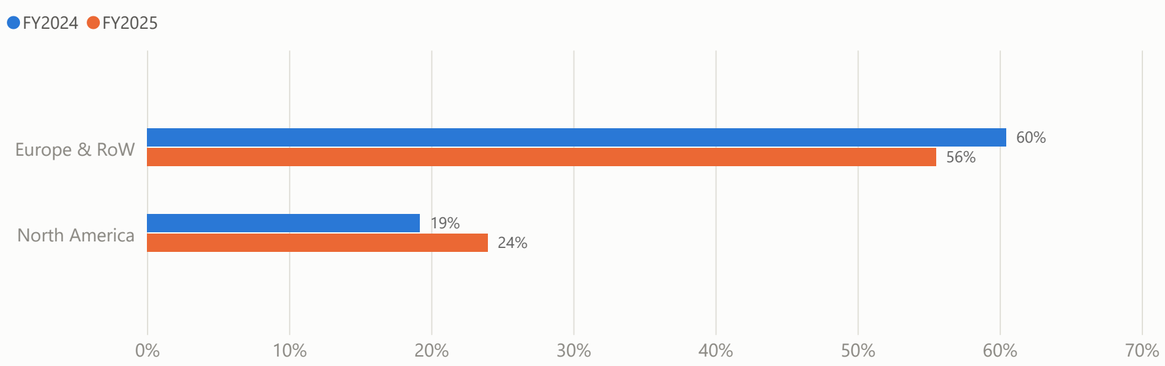
Gambling.com Group: performance-marketing revenue by deal type, % (stacked)



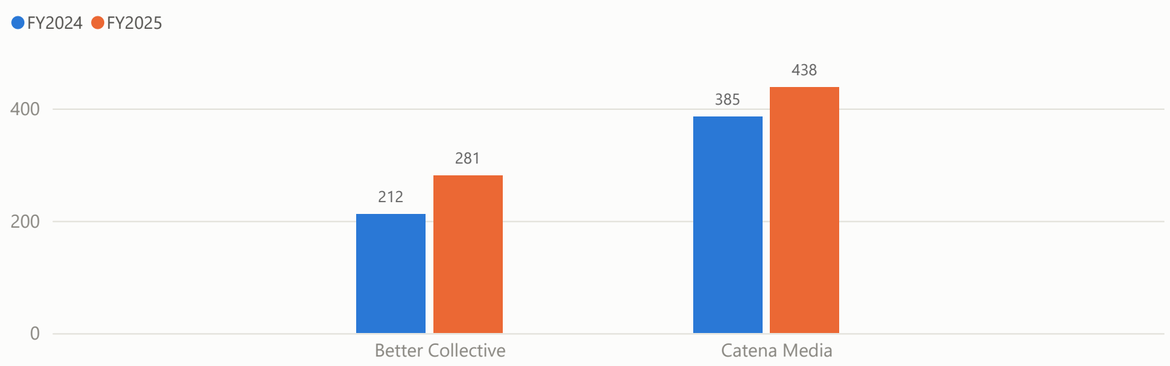
Gambling.com Group: revenue by market, USD thousands (stacked)



Better Collective: revenue share as % of revenue, by region



Revenue per NDC, EUR (total revenue / NDCs)



Sources: Gambling.com Group Form 20-F FY2025 (SEC); Better Collective Annual Report 2025 and Q1-Q3 2025 releases; Catena Media Year-End Report 2025 - see SOURCES.md · Independent case study · Not affiliated with PLAYERSBEST (formerly Growth Leads)

Bonus-code pages earn 7x more per visit than news pages; paid search barely covers its cost

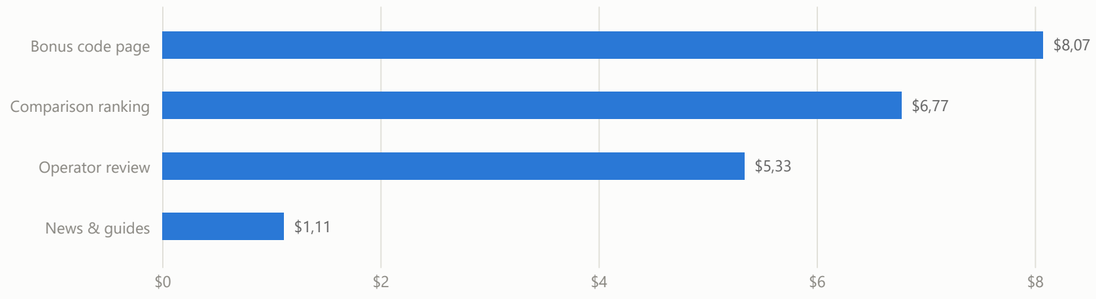
SIMULATED DATA

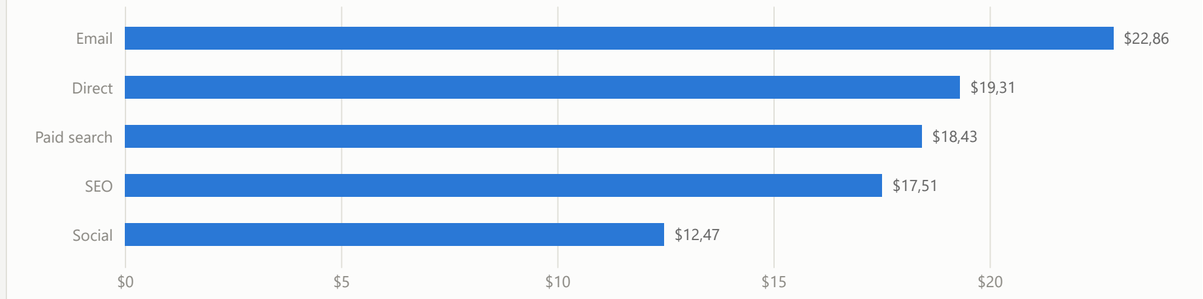
12-month affiliate revenue of NDCs acquired Sep 2024 - Aug 2025, valued under each operator's current deal. Once a visitor clicks out, pages convert alike (EPC about $18): the click-out rate is what separates them. Paid search returns +12% on spend over 12 months, social +104%.

Vertical: Tout

State: Tout

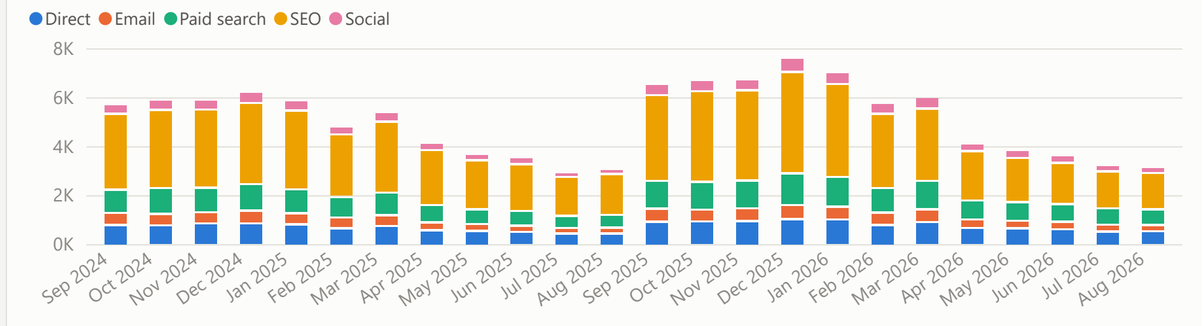
Sessions	Click-out rate	NDCs	EPC (12-month revenue / click-out)	12-month revenue
3M	26,4%	57K	$17,79	$16M





Channel scorecard, Sep 2024 - Aug 2025 cohorts (ROI only for paid channels)

Channel	Sessions	Click-outs	NDCs	NDC / click-out	EPC	Revenue / NDC	Paid spend	ROI
Direct	406 565	112 684	7 345	6,52%	$19,31	$296		
Email	206 945	62 485	4 526	7,24%	$22,86	$316		
Paid search	507 653	143 881	9 785	6,80%	$18,43	$271	$2 370 953	12%
SEO	1 864 037	492 499	30 884	6,27%	$17,51	$279		
Social	405 950	82 857	4 094	4,94%	$12,47	$252	$506 157	104%

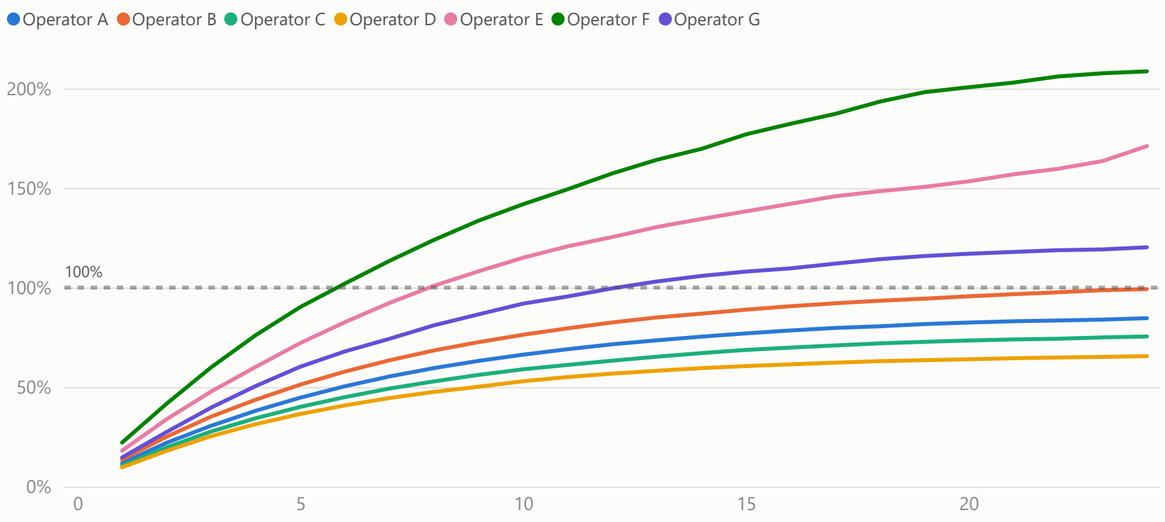


Take CPA for sportsbook, revenue share for casino

SIMULATED DATA

Cumulative revenue-share value per NDC vs the operator's CPA offer, censoring-safe (a month only counts cohorts that could reach it). Sportsbook players churn fast and have losing months: revenue share never reaches the CPA within 24 months. Casino revenue share overtakes CPA by month 6-13 and is worth 1.1-2x the CPA after 24 months, discounted at 10%/year.

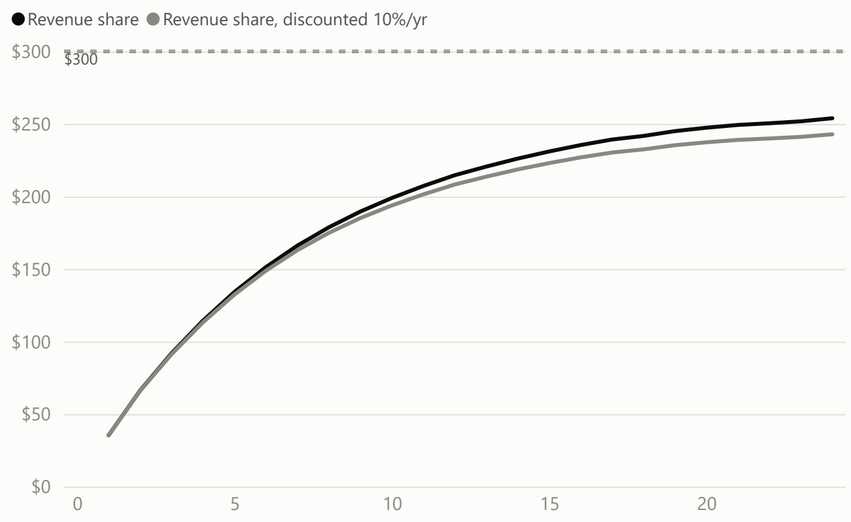
Revenue-share value as % of the CPA offer, by month since first deposit (dashed = break-even)



Pick one operator

- (●) Operator A
- ( ) Operator B
- ( ) Operator C
- ( ) Operator D
- ( ) Operator E
- ( ) Operator F
- ( ) Operator G

Selected operator: cumulative revenue share per NDC, $ (dashed = CPA offer)



Deal scorecard (empty breakeven = revenue share never reaches the CPA within 24 months; 90% bootstrap interval)

Operator	Vertical	Current deal	CPA offer	Rev. share offer	Breakeven month	Breakeven (discounted)	Breakeven P5	Breakeven P95	Rev. share 24m (disc.)	NDCs at month 24	Better deal
Operator A	Sportsbook	CPA	$300	30%					$243	1 983	CPA
Operator B	Sportsbook	Revenue share	$275	30%			21		$261	1 329	CPA
Operator C	Sportsbook	Hybrid	$250	25%					$180	996	CPA
Operator D	Sportsbook	CPA	$250	25%					$157	972	CPA
Operator E	Casino	CPA	$400	35%	8	9	8	9	$644	195	Revenue share
Operator F	Casino	Revenue share	$375	35%	6	6	6	7	$740	114	Revenue share
Operator G	Casino	Hybrid	$350	30%	13	14	10	17	$401	68	Revenue share

Keep the old landing page: the new one does not lift conversion (p = 0.19)

PUBLIC DATASET

290,584 users randomised over 23 days. The new page converts 11.88% vs 12.04% (-0.16 pts, 95% CI -0.39 to +0.08). The test could detect +/-0.34 pts, so a lift of that size would have shown. Stopping at the first daily p < 0.05 would have raised false positives from 5% to 26%: fix the sample size before starting.

Conversion, old page

12,04%

Conversion, new page

11,88%

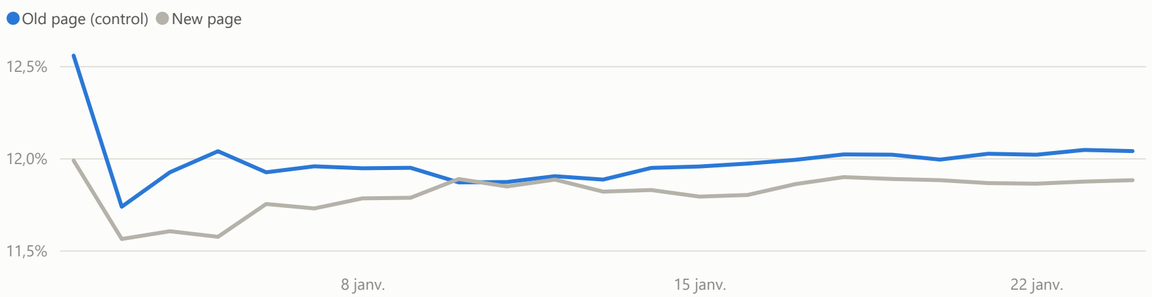
Difference (new - old)

-0,16 pts

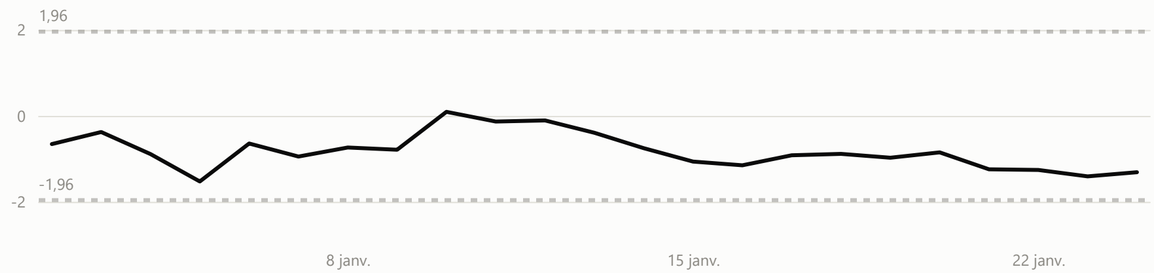
p-value (two-sided z-test)

0,19

Cumulative conversion by day



Cumulative z-score by day (dashed = +/-1.96: crossing it on one day is not a result)



Test statistics

Statistic	Value
Users (control / new page)	145,274 / 145,310
Conversion (control / new page)	12.04% / 11.88%
Difference (new - control)	-0.16 pts (-1.3%)
95% confidence interval	-0.39 to +0.08 pts
z / p-value (two-sided)	-1.31 / 0.190
Bootstrap: share of resamples where new page wins	9.4%
Smallest detectable effect (80% power)	+/-0.34 pts
Users per group to detect +0.5 pts	67,673
False positives, one look at the end (A/A simulation)	5.0%
False positives, peeking every day (A/A simulation)	25.9%

Source: public landing-page A/B test dataset ab_data.csv (Kaggle, origin undocumented), 290,584 users after cleaning · Independent case study · Not affiliated with PLAYERSBEST (formerly Growth Leads)

NFL 2026-27: about +2% NDCs, because the search update cancels a year of growth

SIMULATED DATA

Calendar model (NFL regular season, playoffs, Super Bowl week and day, March Madness, weekdays) back-tested on the whole 2025-26 season: weekly error 0.3% on sessions, season error under 1.5% on NDCs. The 2026-27 forecast adds Missouri (+7% sportsbook sessions) and the March 2026 search update (-14% sessions) as known level changes. Weekly totals.

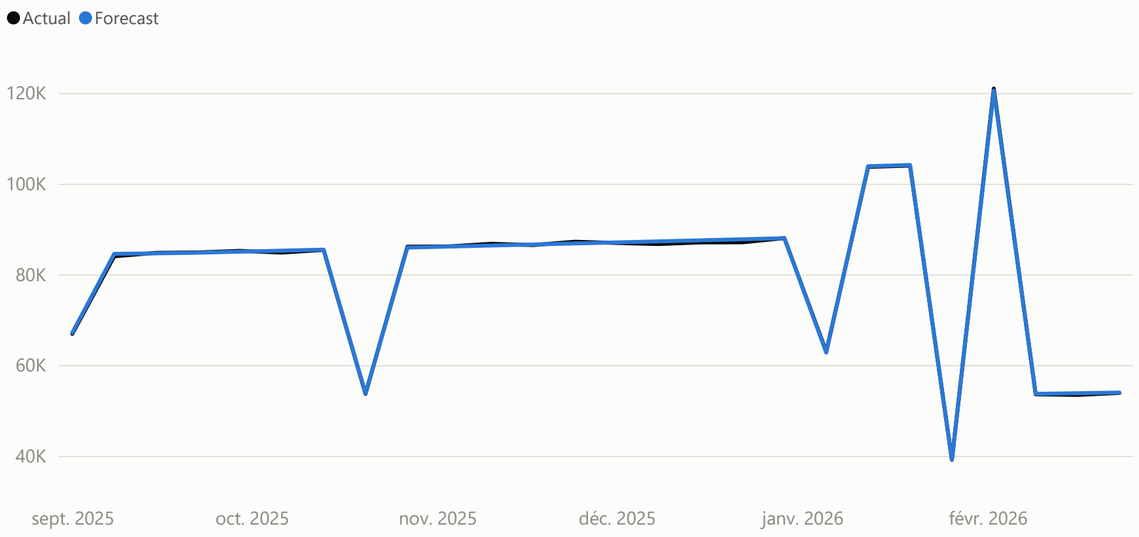
Vertical: Sportsbook

Metric: Sessions

Weekly actuals and forecast for the 2026-27 season (dotted = 80% interval, indicative when summed to weeks)



Back-test: 2025-26 season forecast from 2024-25 only (existing states), weekly



Back-test accuracy (NDCs = sessions x conversion beats a direct NDC model)

Vertical	Metric	Method	Weekly error (MAPE)	Season total error	In 80% interval
Casino	NDCs	Direct GLM	12,8%	-12,2%	71%
Casino	NDCs	Sessions x conversion	9,2%	+0,9%	79%
Casino	Sessions	Calendar GLM	0,9%	-0,1%	84%
Sportsbook	NDCs	Direct GLM	3,7%	+3,4%	75%
Sportsbook	NDCs	Sessions x conversion	3,3%	+0,9%	74%
Sportsbook	Sessions	Calendar GLM	0,3%	+0,1%	96%

Season totals, September to February

Vertical	Metric	2025-26 actual	2026-27 forecast	Growth
Casino	NDCs	2 615	2 533	-3,1%
Casino	Sessions	205 604	200 177	-2,6%
Sportsbook	NDCs	37 495	38 104	+1,6%
Sportsbook	Sessions	2 195 605	2 228 776	+1,5%

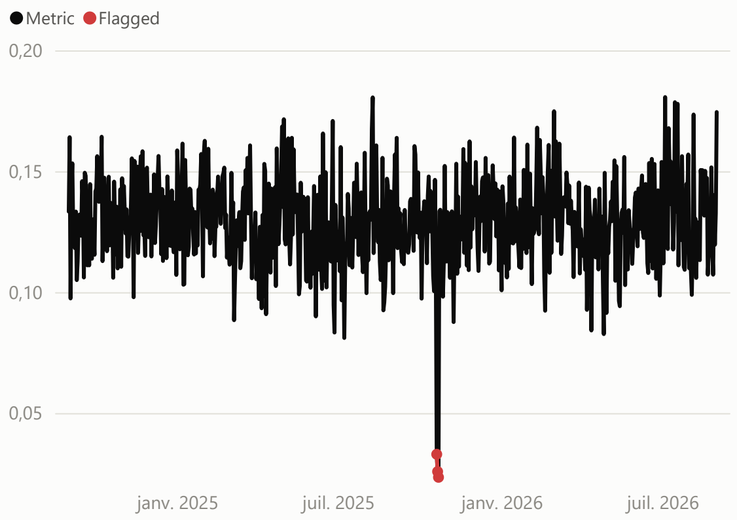
Simulated data (seed 2026), fictional operators A-G, calibrated on public benchmarks - illustrative only · Independent case study · Not affiliated with PLAYERSBEST (formerly Growth Leads)

Watch ratios, not volumes: three anomalies caught within 3 days, zero false alarms

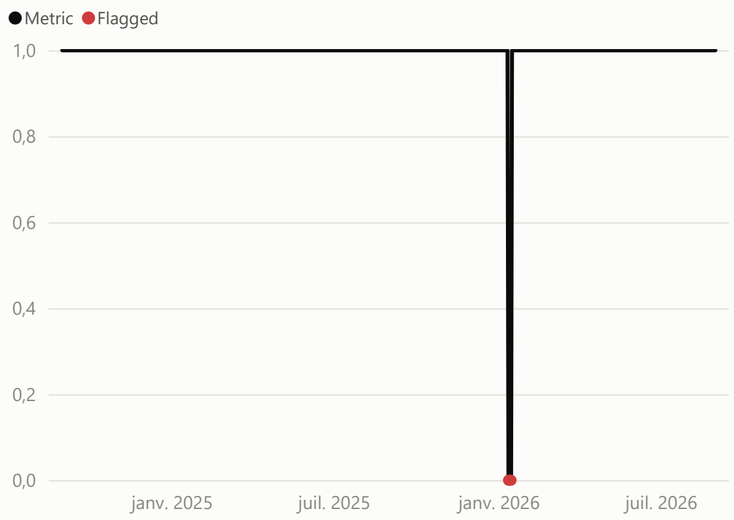
SIMULATED DATA

The rules never saw the answer key. 1) Bots: more click-outs and fewer registrations per click-out (paid search, Illinois). 2) Broken postback: tracked vs operator-reported NDCs (Operator D). 3) Search update: SEO share of sessions vs its 91-day baseline. A plain volume rule raised 58 alarms on the Super Bowl and March Madness instead.

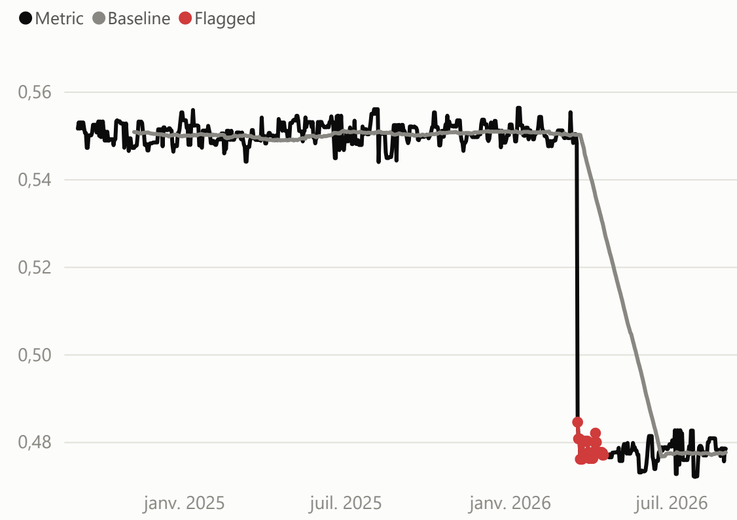
1 · Registrations per click-out, paid search (red = flagged)



2 · Tracked / reported NDCs, Operator D (red = flagged)



3 · SEO share of sessions: 7-day median vs 91-day baseline (red = flagged)



Detection score against the injected anomalies

Anomaly	Started	First flag	Lag (days)	Segment	False alarm days
Bot clicks	20 oct. 2025	20 oct. 2025	0	Paid search	0
Broken tracking	12 janv. 2026	12 janv. 2026	0	Operator D	0
Level shift	15 mars 2026	18 mars 2026	3	SEO	0

What to do when a rule fires

Bot clicks exclude the traffic, block the source and claim back the paid clicks (about $35k bought for bots in 3 days).
Broken tracking reconcile with the operator's report and fix the postback before month-end invoicing; never read a tracking gap as a business drop.
Search update audit the pages that lost rankings, refresh content, and shift budget to email and paid until SEO recovers.